1. Woven baskets characterized by a particular distinctive pattern have previously been found only in the immediate vicinity of the prehistoric village of Palea and therefore were believed to have been made only by the Palean people. Recently, however, archaeologists discovered such a "Palean" basket in Lithos, an ancient village across the Brim River from Palea. The Brim River is very deep and broad, and so the ancient Paleans could have crossed it only by boat, and no Palean boats have been found. Thus it follows that the so-called Palean baskets were not uniquely Palean.

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The author of the passage concludes that the so- called Palean baskets were not uniquely Palean. Her conclusion is mainly based on the following pieces of evidence. First, a basket similar to the Palean basket was discovered in Lithos. Second, Lithos was separated from Palean by a deep and broad river. Third, no Palean boats have been discovered. But she does not provide enough evidence to fully support the conclusion.

First, she mentions that the Brim River is very deep and broad, so she infers that the anc ient Paleans could have crossed it only by boat. She clearly assumes that there is no other method to cross a deep and broad river. However, perhaps the river became frozen in winter, so people could walk across it. Or, people could go around the river's source. Thus, without more evidence to exclude these possibilities, the people could still be able to take the basket from Palea to lithos without having to take a boat.

Second, she also mentions that no Palean boats have been found, implying that the Paleans did not have boats. She clearly assumes that if there were boats, they should have been found by now. However, ancient boats could have been made of wood, so they decayed fast. Consequently, people can't find any direct evidence for their existence , even if they existed. Therefore, the author needs to rely on indirect evidence to exclude the existence of Palean boats.

Finally, even if Paleans had no boats , and the baskets could only reach the other side of the river by boats, it does not necessarily mean that the basket discovered in Lithos did not come from Palea. Perhaps the basket was still made by Paleans. Some Paleans might have travelled to Lithos, and they made the basket in Lithos. Also, people from other places could have had boats. They could have used their boats to carry the baskets from Palea to Lithos. Thus, the author needs to provide more evidence to rule out this possibility; otherwise, she cannot firmly conclude that the baskets were not uniquely Palean.

7. The following is a recommendation from the Board of Directors of Monarch Books.
"We recommend that Monarch Books open a café in its store. Monarch, having been in business at the same location for more than twenty years, has a large customer base because it is known for its wide selection of books on all subjects. Clearly, opening the café would attract more customers. Space could be made for the café by discontinuing the children's book section, which will probably become less popular given that the most recent national census indicated a significant decline in the percentage of the population under age ten. Opening a café will allow Monarch to attract more customers and better compete with Regal Books, which recently opened its own café."

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation is likely to have the predicted result. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation. In this argument, the author recommends Monarch Books to open a cafe in its book store. However, the evidence is insufficient.

First, given that Monarch has been in business for many years and thus has accumulated a large customer base, the author concludes that the cafe will attract more customers. In this reasoning, the arguer assumes that the store's reputation or large consumer base in book selling can help its coffee business. Yet, in reality, books and food are totally different things. The book store has accumulated lots of consumers because of a wide selection of books on all subjects. However, it has no experience in restaurant operation at all. How can having various books promote food sales? In fact, people who go to the cafe may doubt its professionality and choose other more professional cafes. The arguer should provide more information to answer this question.

Second, we can infer from the argument that there is no available space for a cafe. And the author suggests to discontinue the children's book section because the most recent national census indicated a significant decline in the percentage of the population under age ten. Apparently , the author assumes that the national census can be applied to the store's location. However, the general census is the average trend of the nation, and this particular location may not necessarily conform to the general trend. For example, there may be many primary schools in this area. If so, the population under ten in this area is not decreasing, and discontinuing the children's book section would generate great loss to Monarch Books. Thus, the author should provide the specific characteristics of its location, like how many primary schools, to determine whether the national census can be applied or not.

Finally, the author asserts that a cafe will allow Monarch to better compete with Regal Books, which recently opened its own cafe. In this assertion, the author assumes that Regal Books' cafe gives it competitive advantages. However, Regal Books may not have hired professional baristas. This could lead to bad taste of its coffee and snacks. In turn, the bad taste of could discourage many consumers, possibly disappointing many loyal consumers of the Regal Books. Thus, the presence of the cafe may not give Regal Books any competitive advantages. Then, there is no reason for Monarch to open a cafe to compete with Regal. Instead, Monarch should not follow Regal's example and should not open a cafe in its book store. So, the author should provide the information about the operational situation of the cafe in Regal.

In short, the author should provide more evidence to address the questions and concerns above to help me to evaluate the recommendation.

10. Twenty years ago, Dr. Field, a noted anthropologist, visited the island of Tertia. Using an observation-centered approach to studying Tertian culture, he concluded from his observations that children in Tertia were reared by an entire village rather than by their own biological parents. Recently another anthropologist, Dr. Karp, visited the group of islands that includes Tertia and used the interview-centered method to study child-rearing practices. In the interviews that Dr. Karp conducted with children living in this group of islands, the children spent much more time talking about their biological parents than about other adults in the village. Dr. Karp decided that Dr. Field's conclusion about Tertian village culture must be invalid. Some anthropologists recommend that to obtain accurate information on Tertian child-rearing practices, future research on the subject should be conducted via the interview-centered method.

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

In this article, several anthropologists recommend that future research on Tertian child- rearing practices use the interview- centered method. The recommendation is based on Dr. Karp's recent research, which seems to indicate that the interview- centered method is more reliable than the observation- centered approach used by Dr. Field. However, important questions are left unaddressed, so the argument is not as persuasive as the author intended.

First, it is unclear whether Dr. Karp' s conclusion is more believable than Dr. Field' s. Dr. Karp' s main evidence is that the local children talked about their parents more than about other adults, so she implies that this is because they were reared by their biological parents, not by the entire village. However, there could be other reasons. Do the children speak more about their birthparents just because they are emotionally closer? If they are genetically related, chances are high that they are similar, and more likely to establish a bond. Without addressing this possibility, she cannot simply infer that the children are raised by their birthparents.

Second, because of her research results, Dr. Karp decided that Dr. Field's conclusion must be wrong. However, couldn't they both be correct? After all, the two studies were separated by 20 years. A lot of things can have happened during that time. The local traditions might have changed vastly. It is possible that 20 years ago, children were generally supported by a whole tribe, but today individual families have become the popular trend. Thus, it is important to look into any changes in local convention during this time, before quickly rejecting Dr. Field's study.

Last, because of Dr. Karp's conclusion, other anthropologists now recommend that all future research adopt the interview- centered method. However, are there any other good approaches to adopt besides the two mentioned? Even if not, is the interview- centered method suitable for every study? Readers don't know, and no further evidence is provided. Unless these researchers can demonstrate that the interview- centered approach is always the best choice, their recommendation may actually hurt future investigations.

Overall, the information in the passage is lacking. The aforementioned questions have to be answered before these researchers can successfully show that their advice is worth following.

13. In an attempt to improve highway safety, Prunty County last year lowered its speed limit from 55 to 45 miles per hour on all county highways. But this effort has failed: the number of accidents has not decreased, and, based on reports by the highway patrol, many drivers are exceeding the speed limit. Prunty County should instead undertake the same kind of road improvement project that Butler County completed five years ago: increasing lane widths, resurfacing rough highways, and improving visibility at dangerous intersections. Today, major Butler County roads still have a 55 mph speed limit, yet there were 25 percent fewer reported accidents in Butler County this past year than there were five years ago.

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The author suggests that Prunty County (PC) undertake the same kind of road improvement project that Butler County (BC) completed five years ago: increasing lane widths, resurfacing rough highways, and improving visibility at dangerous intersections. However, the evidence provided in the passage is insufficient to corroborate this suggestion.

First, the author believes that PC should not lower its speed limits , because last year, the decision to lower speed limits from 55 to 45 miles per hour failed. Her evidence is that the number of accidents has not decreased since, and that highway patrol reported that many drivers are exceeding the speed limit. Clearly, she assumes that the seriousness of these accidents has not changed much, and that the number of drivers exceeding the speed limit has not dropped. However, perhaps there are fewer serious accidents now, so the new regulation has worked. Also, the author does not mention how many drivers used to exceed speed limit. Perhaps there were a lot more in the past. More information is needed to rule out these possibilities.

Second, the author recommends that PC learn from BC, because after BC adopted its road improvement project 5 years ago, there were 25 percent fewer reported accidents this past year than 5 years ago, assuming that this last year was representative, and that all accidents are reported. However, what about the five years in between? Perhaps this last year was an anomaly. Also, maybe there is insufficient police force , so many accidents went unnoticed. The author needs to offer additional information to rule out these possibilities.

Last, the author assumes that PC today and BC five years ago are similar. However, no such information is offered. The two places could be drastically different in size and population. They could have totally different traffic regulations, and their road conditions could also be dissimilar. These could all cause the efforts to fail in PC, even though they worked in BC 5 years ago.

All in all, the author needs to supply the aforementioned information. Otherwise, her conclusion cannot persuade readers.

15. The following memorandum is from the business manager of Happy Pancake House restaurants.

"Recently, butter has been replaced by margarine in Happy Pancake House restaurants throughout the southwestern United States. This change, however, has had little impact on our customers. In fact, only about 2 percent of customers have complained, indicating that an average of 98 people out of 100 are happy with the change. Furthermore, many servers have reported that a number of customers who ask for butter do not complain when they are given margarine instead. Clearly, either these customers do not distinguish butter from margarine or they use the term 'butter' to refer to either butter or margarine."

Write a response in which you discuss one or more alternative explanations that could rival the proposed explanation and explain how your explanation(s) can plausibly account for the facts presented in the argument.

In this memorandum, the author concludes that their customers do not distinguish butter from margarine, or they use the term "butter" to refer to either butter or margarine. However, her inference is based on insufficient evidence, and other explanations could equally account for the information presented.

For starters, the author mentions that after Happy Pancake House restaurants replaced their butter with margarine, only about 2 percent of customers complained, indicating that 98% of people were happy with the change. Clearly, she assumes that 2% is a small amount, and that all unhappy customers would complain. However, maybe most restaurants have a lower proportion of complaints, and the 2% is already high enough to influence the restaurant's reputation. Also, customers don't always complain when they are angry. They sometimes don't bother speaking up; instead, they just leave and never return again. Without evidence ruling out these possibilities, the author's conclusion does not firmly stand.

In addition, the author mentions that many servers have reported that a number of customers who ask for butter do not complain when they are given margarine. Apparently, she assumes that servers are always honest. However, not all servers will tell their bosses about every customer complaint. Perhaps servers who receive the most complaints could be fired or have their wages cut, so they have reason to hide the information. We just don't know if these possibilities are true, unless the author can offer more evidence to clarify the uncertainty.

Last, even if the above possibilities are ruled out, it does not necessarily follow that customers don't distinguish between butter and margarine or use the terms interchangeably. The author assumes that no other explanation exists. However, maybe they are just nice people who are willing to accept everything the restaurant offers. They know the difference, but they just won't say anything. Maybe when they see that they are not given not what they want, they don't use the margarine at all.

In sum, these above possibilities could all equally explain the evidence offered by the out. Without ruling them out, her conclusion cannot stand on firm ground.

17. The following is a memorandum from the business manager of a television station.

"Over the past year, our late-night news program has devoted increased time to national news and less time to weather and local news. During this period, most of the complaints received from viewers were concerned with our station's coverage of weather and local news. In addition, local businesses that used to advertise during our late-night news program have canceled their advertising contracts with us. Therefore, in order to attract more viewers to our news programs and to avoid losing any further advertising revenues, we should expand our coverage of weather and local news on all our news programs."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

The passage recommends that the television station expand its coverage of weather and local news on all their news programs in order to attract more viewers and to avoid losing further advertising revenues. However, underlying in its line of reasoning are several unwarranted assumptions that seriously undermine its persuasiveness.

First, the author mentions that most of the complaints the station received from viewers were concerned with its coverage of weather and local news , assuming that these complaints are representative of the audience. However, perhaps there were few complaints, so even if all of them were about a particular issue, it doesn't really matter much. In fact, perhaps before the reduction in local and weather news, there used to be more complaints. Therefore, without ruling this possibility out, the complaints lend little support to the author's suggestion.

Second, she also mentions that several local businesses have canceled their advertising contracts with the station. Clearly, she assumes that the reduction in weather and local news was the very reason for these cancelations. However, several possible explanations could equally account for these results. Perhaps the station has raised its prices for advertising spots. Maybe these businesses have gone bankrupt. Without considering all explanations, the author has not successfully proven that people would like to see more weather and local news.

Last, granted that viewers and businesses were both unhappy with the reduction in local and weather news, it does not necessarily mean that increasing their coverage is the best way to attract a greater audience and increased advertising revenue. The author assumes that there is no better approach for dealing with the matter. Perhaps the station could hire a more professional news anchor. Maybe it could increase the diversity of its news. Without considering other measures, the author's suggestion appears too simple.

Overall, the aforementioned assumptions all render the author's argument weak. Further evidence is needed to fill these loopholes.

20. According to a recent report, cheating among college and university students is on the rise. However, Groveton College has successfully reduced student cheating by adopting an honor code, which calls for students to agree not to cheat in their academic endeavors and to notify a faculty member if they suspect that others have cheated. Groveton's honor code replaced a system in which teachers closely monitored students; under that system, teachers reported an average of thirty cases of cheating per year. In the first year the honor code was in place, students reported twenty-one cases of cheating; five years later, this figure had dropped to fourteen. Moreover, in a recent survey, a majority of Groveton students said that they would be less likely to cheat with an honor code in place than without. Thus, all colleges and universities should adopt honor codes similar to Groveton's in order to decrease cheating among students.
Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the recommendation and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the recommendation.

In this passage, the author believes that all colleges and universities should adopt honor codes in order to decrease cheating problems. The honor codes are a set of policies which call for students to agree not to cheat in their academic endeavors, and to notify a faculty member if they suspect that others have cheated. The author's opinion is based on a change in reported cheating problems and a survey from students. However, her argument is filled with unwarranted assumptions that may seriously undermine the cogency of her reasoning.
To begin, the author assumes that the amount of cheating reflected in students' notifications represents the actual amount of cheating. But are the reports truthful? As we can see, students may conceal actual cases of cheating in order to benefit themselves in such an honor code system, so it is reasonable to believe that the amount of cheating is greatly underestimated. What's more , students may be so focused on the exams that they are unable to discern cheating around them. As a result, the author cannot reach an accurate conclusion about the decline of cheating unless she proves that the students' reports truly reflect the actual cheating situation.
Even if the amount of cheating reported by students is accurate , there are other assumptions the author needs to justify. We judge the degree of cheating problems through the ratio of cheating , so the author makes an assumption that the amount of cheating, as she mentioned in her passage , reflects the relative ratio of cheating. However, in many cases, the absolute number does not reflect the relative number exactly. For instance, if the number of students who take the exam decreases dramatically, we cannot determine a change in the proportion of cheating students. As a result, the author needs to provide more details about the number of students who take the exam

in order to eliminate the flaws of her assumptions.

Finally, are other colleges' situations similar to Groveton' s? In general, if the conditions of the two elements are similar, if something is suitable for the former it can be applied to the latter. However, we all know that each college is unique, because of numerous factors such as policy, location, climate, culture and so on, contribute to the circumstances of the college simultaneously. Given that colleges have such complicated influences, it is extremely arbitrary to apply the situation of Groveton to other colleges. She needs to scrutinize the circumstances of other colleges and, based on those results, apply the honor code only to suitable places.

Overall, all of the assumptions above should be proven or revise d in order to make the passage more cogent and reliable.

22. A recently issued twenty-year study on headaches suffered by the residents of Mentia investigated the possible therapeutic effect of consuming salicylates. Salicylates are members of the same chemical family as aspirin, a medicine used to treat headaches. Although many foods are naturally rich in salicylates, food-processing companies also add salicylates to foods as preservatives. The twenty-year study found a correlation between the rise in the commercial use of salicylates and a steady decline in the average number of headaches reported by study participants. At the time when the study concluded, food-processing companies had just discovered that salicylates can also be used as flavor additives for foods, and, as a result, many companies plan to do so. Based on these study results, some health experts predict that residents of Mentia will suffer even fewer headaches in the future.

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the prediction and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the prediction.

In this article, some health experts predict that residents of Mentia will suffer fewer headaches in the future. However, several questions remain unanswered, so the persuasiveness of this argument is still in doubt.

For starters, the author mentions that salicylates are members of the same chemical family as aspirin, a medicine used to treat headaches, implying that salicylates can help with headaches as well. Clearly, she assumes that every chemical in the same family would have the same function. However, maybe the similarity between salicylates and aspirin is simply their color or taste, while they don't have the same medical function. Therefore, without knowing how similar these two really are, the comparison is quite unconvincing.

Second, the author mentions that a twenty- year study found a correlation between the rise in commercial use of salicylates and a decline in the average number of headaches reported by study participants. Apparently, she assumes that it is the intake of salicylates that explains the decline in headache instances. However, perhaps local residents exercise now more than before; perhaps their environment is cleaner than before. These can also potentially explain the trend. Therefore, she must answer the question of whether there are other phenomena that may explain the trend. Otherwise, the connection between salicylates and headaches is still unclear.

Last, she also states that several food companies are considering using salicylates as flavor additives. Obviously, she assumes that people will like these foods with salicylates. However, they may taste awful; or perhaps the production costs will rise, making these foods pricier than other similar products. If these happen, people will not necessarily consume more salicylates than

before. Thus, the author has to provide more evidence to show whether people in Mentia will consume more salicylates than before ; otherwise, the companies' plan will not be relevant to the prediction. Overall, all aforementioned questions are crucial in the evaluation of the author's argument. Without addressing any of them, her conclusion will remain debatable.

23. The following was written as a part of an application for a small-business loan by a group of developers in the city of Monroe.

"A jazz music club in Monroe would be a tremendously profitable enterprise. Currently, the nearest jazz club is 65 miles away; thus, the proposed new jazz club in Monroe, the C-Note, would have the local market all to itself. Plus, jazz is extremely popular in Monroe: over 100,000 people attended Monroe's annual jazz festival last summer; several well-known jazz musicians live in Monroe; and the highest-rated radio program in Monroe is 'Jazz Nightly,' which airs every weeknight at 7 P.M. Finally, a nationwide study indicates that the typical jazz fan spends close to $1,000 per year on jazz entertainment."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The article claims that a jazz club in Monroe would be a profitable enterprise. However, the author's line of reasoning suffers from several loopholes that need to be supplemented by further evidence.

To begin with, the author believes that the proposed jazz club, C- Note, would have the local market all to itself, since the nearest jazz club is 65 miles away. Apparently, she assumes that C-Note would be able to attract all the nearby jazz fans. However, perhaps the club would book poor performers, its service would be terrible, and its decor outdated. All of this could make the club unattractive to visitors. Therefore, the author has to provide related evidence to address these concerns.

Furthermore, the author guarantees that jazz music is popular in Monroe, because over 100, 000 people attended Monroe's annual jazz festival last summer, several well- known jazz musicians live there, and the highest- rated radio program in Monroe is“ Jazz Nightly” . However, none of these facts are sufficient to prove the popularity of jazz. Maybe most of the visitors to the festival were from out of town, while local residents were quite inactive; the jazz musicians may have retired or have no business in Monroe; the radio program' s popularity may be confined within a tiny group of jazz fans, while it has little influence on other people. In short, the author needs more specific evidence to eliminate these possibilities, or else it will remain unclear how well- received jazz is in Monroe.

Finally, the author cites a nationwide study which indicates that the typical jazz fan spends close to$ 1, 000 per year on jazz entertainment. Clearly, she assumes that the study reflects the particular situation in Monroe. However, perhaps Monroe is the poorest region in the country, so even though it has many jazz fans, they are rarely able to afford frequent visits to a jazz club. Thus,

the author had better draw a survey on local residents' purchasing power, before she predicts that the jazz club would make money in Monroe.
In conclusion, the article is missing important information on all aforementioned aspects. Thus, the author's claim that C- Note would be profitable does not s tand on solid ground.

30. The following appeared in a memo from a vice president of Quiot Manufacturing.
"During the past year, Quiot Manufacturing had 30 percent more on-the-job accidents than at the nearby Panoply Industries plant, where the work shifts are one hour shorter than ours. Experts say that significant contributing factors in many on-the-job accidents are fatigue and sleep deprivation among workers. Therefore, to reduce the number of on-the-job accidents at Quiot and thereby increase productivity, we should shorten each of our three work shifts by one hour so that employees will get adequate amounts of sleep."
Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

In the article, the author recommends that Quiot Manufacturing (QM) reduce each of its three work shifts by one hour to reduce the number of on- the- job accidents. Unfortunately, her argument rests on several unwarranted assumptions that make its reasoning unconvincing.
For starters, based on the fact that QM had 30% more on- the- job accidents than the nearby Panoply Industries (PI) , where the work shifts are one hour shorter, the author implies that it is because of the longer work shifts that QM had more accidents. Apparently, the author assumes that no other explanation can account for this data. However, perhaps QM is simply much larger than PI. Perhaps QM's equipment is outdated and thus more dangerous to operate. These differences have to be ruled out in order for the author to draw a connection between the length of work shifts and accident rate.
In addition, to further strengthen the relationship between work hours and accidents , the author cites an expert opinion, that significant contributing factors in many on- the- job accidents are fatigue and sleep deprivation among workers. Apparently, she assumes that the expert's analysis is relevant to QM's particular case. However, maybe QM's work shifts, even though longer than PI's, are not really demanding for the workers, so the workers are not exhausted after their work shifts. Therefore, instead of applying the expert's opinion, the author needs to draw direct evidence based on QM's particular case.
Finally, even if QM's relatively higher accident rate is caused by the longer work shifts , that does not necessarily mean that shortening the work shifts will alleviate the problem. The author assumes that after shortening the work shifts by one hour, workers will get adequate rest. However, it is quite possible that total work load will remain the same, so the shorter work shift means that workers will have to work more efficiently. If so, the intense pressure may still cause

the workers to be overly stressed and exhausted. Therefore, without providing more information to address this concern, the author's advice still sounds unconvincing.
Overall, these missing links make the author's reasoning unsound. To further corroborate her suggestion, she has to provide more evidence in order to dispel the aforementioned co ncerns.

34. The following report appeared in the newsletter of the West Meria Public Health Council.
"An innovative treatment has come to our attention that promises to significantly reduce absenteeism in our schools and workplaces. A study reports that in nearby East Meria, where fish consumption is very high, people visit the doctor only once or twice per year for the treatment of colds. Clearly, eating a substantial amount of fish can prevent colds. Since colds represent the most frequently given reason for absences from school and work, we recommend the daily use of Ichthaid — a nutritional supplement derived from fish oil — as a good way to prevent colds and lower absenteeism."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The author recommends the daily use of Ichthaid— a nutritional supplement derived from fish oil — as a good way to prevent colds and reduce absences from work and school. However, to fully evaluate the argument, more evidence is desperately needed.
For starters, the author cites a study which reports that in nearby East Meria , where fish consumption is high, people visit the doctors only once or twice per year to treat colds. Hence, she suggests that eating a substantial amount of fish can prevent colds. Clearly, she assumes that no other factors aside from a diet rich in fish could explain this data. However, perhaps East Merians exercise more often than people elsewhere; perhaps the local climate is mild and uniform, making colds less likely. To fully establish a link between fish and colds, the author has to offer further evidence to rule out these possibilities.
Second, even if fish can help reduce colds , there is no guarantee that Ichthaid can do the same just because it is derived from fish oil. The author apparently assumes that Ichthaid has the same function as fish. However, maybe the key element in fish that helps with colds doesn't lie in its oil. Perhaps during the manufacturing process, all effective elements are decomposed and lose their function. Thus, until relevant information is provided, readers cannot be fully convinced of Ichthaid's potential in dealing with colds.
Last, even if Ichthaid can effectively reduce colds, the recommendation for its daily intake is not necessarily advisable. The author assumes that its side effects are not more significant. However, perhaps some people are allergic to fish oil, so they should stay away from the product. Perhaps using it daily could cause stomachaches or headaches. The author says nothing about Ichthaid's potential harms, but every substance has some side effects. Therefore, to fully dispel consumers'

potential worries, the author had better provide more relevant information.
Overall, the argument provides some, but not all important evidence for a thorough evaluation of Ichthaid. Until more evidence is provided, readers should remain skeptical towards the author's recommendation.

37. A recent sales study indicates that consumption of seafood dishes in Bay City restaurants has increased by 30 percent during the past five years. Yet there are no currently operating city restaurants whose specialty is seafood. Moreover, the majority of families in Bay City are two-income families, and a nationwide study has shown that such families eat significantly fewer home-cooked meals than they did a decade ago but at the same time express more concern about healthful eating. Therefore, the new Captain Seafood restaurant that specializes in seafood should be quite popular and profitable.

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The article believes that the new Captain Seafood restaurant（CSR）, which specializes in seafood will be popular and profitable. However, the author has yet to provide sufficient evidence for readers to fully evaluate its reasoning.
For starters, she mentions a recent sales study which shows that consumption of seafood dishes in Bay City restaurants has increased by 30 percent during the past five years. However, the data does not necessarily indicate that seafood is now more popular in Bay City than five years ago. The author assumes that no other factors could explain this figure. However, perhaps the local population has increased vastly, or perhaps there are many more tourists today than in the past. These possibilities could be all the cause of the change, so the author needs to provide more information to rule out these circumstances.
Second, according to the author, the majority of families in Bay City are two- income families, and according to a nationwide study, these families tend to eat out more and care more about healthy eating. However, this information does not prove that seafood is a local favorite. The author assumes that eating healthy is related to eating seafood. However, it is possible that most people would choose organic vegetables or whole grains when they think about eating healthily. They may rarely choose seafood because they believe it is high in cholesterol. Therefore, the author needs to do a more specific survey to ask local people how much they prefer seafood. Without more solid information, her argument is prone to counterarguments.
Last, the author mentions that CSR is the only restaurant that specializes in seafood , but it does not necessarily mean that it has no competition. The author assumes that when people want to eat seafood, they prefer a place that specializes in seafood. However, there may be many other restaurants that have good at cooking seafood, even though they may serve many other things as

well. In contrast, CSR' s seafood may taste awful, even though seafood is all it has. Therefore, the author needs to provide more specific information regarding CSR' s quality, or else it will remain unclear how profitable CSR is going to be.
Overall, the author should offer more evidence to address all of the above counterarguments.

39. The following appeared in a health newsletter.

"A ten-year nationwide study of the effectiveness of wearing a helmet while bicycling indicates that ten years ago, approximately 35 percent of all bicyclists reported wearing helmets, whereas today that number is nearly 80 percent. Another study, however, suggests that during the same ten-year period, the number of bicycle-related accidents has increased 200 percent. These results demonstrate that bicyclists feel safer because they are wearing helmets, and they take more risks as a result. Thus, to reduce the number of serious injuries from bicycle accidents, the government should concentrate more on educating people about bicycle safety and less on encouraging or requiring bicyclists to wear helmets."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

In the article, the author recommends that the government concentrate more on educating people about bicycle safety, and less on encouraging or requiring bicyclists to wear helmets. However, her reasoning suffers from several assumptions and loopholes that seriously undermine its cogency.
To begin with, she mentions a ten- year nationwide study , which indicates that, while ten years ago , about 35% of bicyclists reported wearing helmets , today that number has increased to nearly 80%. However, the changed dat a does not necessarily imply that more cyclists wear helmets today than before. The author assumes that everyone would honestly report his/ her behavior, when in reality this is often not the case. Maybe ten years ago traffic regulations did not require wearing helmets, so people would honestly tell surveyors about what they did. In contrast, there might be stricter rules requiring that people wear helmets, so even if some people don't follow the rule, they may still openly lie about it to look better. Therefore, without more direct observation, the author has not provided persuasive evidence to corroborate her reasoning.
Second, the author also mentions that the number of bicycle- related accidents has increased by 200%, and she then attributes this increase to helmet use. Clearly, she assumes that no other factors could equally account for this trend. However, maybe there are many more cars on the road, while road conditions have not improved, so it is perhaps more risky to ride a bike now than before. There might be more bicyclists as well, so increased accidents might simply be a natural

result of increased bike riders. In a nutshell, without evidence ruling out these possibilities, the author cannot firmly establish a link between safety and helmet wearing.
Last, even if wearing a helmet does not help reduce accidents , that does not necessarily mean that education is the only way to go. The author assumes that no other solution could better deal with the issue. However, perhaps the local government has already emphasized the importance of safe riding, but that hasn't worked at all. Instead, what it really should do is spend more money on widening the roads, resurfacing them, adding bicycle lanes, and setting stricter car driving regulations. The author cannot offer a strong conclusion without addressing other alternative proposals.
Overall, the author's line of reasoning is weak, and ha s too many unwarranted assumptions. Only by providing more evidence can she potentially persuade readers to accept her suggestion.

43. The following is part of a memorandum from the president of Humana University.

"Last year the number of students who enrolled in online degree programs offered by nearby Omni University increased by 50 percent. During the same year, Omni showed a significant decrease from prior years in expenditures for dormitory and classroom space, most likely because instruction in the online programs takes place via the Internet. In contrast, over the past three years, enrollment at Humana University has failed to grow, and the cost of maintaining buildings has increased along with our budget deficit. To address these problems, Humana University will begin immediately to create and actively promote online degree programs like those at Omni. We predict that instituting these online degree programs will help Humana both increase its total enrollment and solve its budget problems."

Write a response in which you discuss what questions would need to be answered in order to decide whether the prediction and the argument on which it is based are reasonable. Be sure to explain how the answers to these questions would help to evaluate the prediction.

The article predicts that the newly installed online degree programs will help Humana University（HU） increase its total enrollment and solve its budget problems. Unfortunately, several questions are open to debate, so the author's prediction is still unpersuasive.
For starters, the author mentions that Omni University（OU） showed a significant decrease in expenses for dormitory and classroom space , as the number of students enrolled in online degree programs increased by 50 percent. Thus, she believes that the reduced expenses must be due to online instruction, assuming that the reduction couldn't have been caused by other changes. However, has the school lowered its tuition？ Did it hire more prestigious professors？ Did it start a new advertising campaign to attract prospective students？ The author provides no evidence to rule out these alternative possibilities, so its connection between online courses and expense reduction is weak.
Second, even if OU's online program has contributed to lower expenses , that does not necessarily mean that HU's online program will have the same results. The author assumes that the two programs are similar in several important aspects. However, maybe OU's program focuses on humanities courses, while HU's programs are based on science and technology. If so, then it is unclear whether HU's online classes will be well received. Therefore, to fully substantiate the

comparison, the author must address the question of whether HU's online program is going to successfully attract students from real classrooms.

Finally, even if HU' s online classes will help reduce its expenses on classroom and dormitory space, that does not necessarily help alleviate its budget problems. The author assumes that the school's revenue would not decline faster, and that increases in other expenses will not compensate for the reduced costs of classroom and dorm maintenance. However, will the online programs charge less than traditional classes? If so, then having students take courses online would probably mean that the school will receive less tuition money. Also, setting up a new online program costs a lot of money, but how much? The author does not indicate. If the cost is excessive, then the school may end up in heavier debt.

Overall, the aforementioned questions are all crucial in corroborating the author's line of reasoning. Only with more evidence can readers be in a position to readily evaluate her prediction.

44. The following appeared in a memorandum from the owner of Movies Galore, a chain of movie-rental stores.

"Because of declining profits, we must reduce operating expenses at Movies Galore's ten movie-rental stores. Raising prices is not a good option, since we are famous for our low prices. Instead, we should reduce our operating hours. Last month our store in downtown Marston reduced its hours by closing at 6:00 p.m. rather than 9:00 p.m. and reduced its overall inventory by no longer stocking any DVD released more than five years ago. Since we have received very few customer complaints about these new policies, we should now adopt them at all other Movies Galore stores as our best strategies for improving profits."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The author recommends that all locations of the chain store Movies Galore reduce their operating hours by closing at 6: 00 p. m. rather than 9: 00 p. m., and stop stocking any DVDS released more than five years ago. However, more evidence is needed to fully evaluate her line of reasoning.

For starters, the author believes that the stores should not raise prices , because they are famous for low prices. Clearly, she assumes that a store known for its low prices should never raise prices. However, perhaps its fees are so low that their reputation has become a burden. Even if they raise prices moderately, the prices can still be lower than their competitors, and the change wouldn't hurt their reputation. Thus, the author needs to provide specific data comparing Movies Galore and their competitors' prices before she makes this inference.

Second, the author mentions that the branch store in downtown Marston reduced its operating hours and reduced inventory, and that since then, the store has received few customer complaints. However, few customer complaints do not necessarily mean that customers are happy about the change. The statement assumes that all unsatisfied customers would complain. However, in reality, a discontent customer might simply choose other places to rent movies, and Movies Galore's business might have suffered a serious blow. Thus, the author needs to investigate that branch store's profits before suggesting that every branch store imitate the policy.

Finally, even if that particular store in downtown Marston successfully implemented the policy , it does not necessarily mean that other stores should do the same. The author assumes that all the

stores are similar in clientele. However, perhaps most clients of that store normally visit before 6: 00 p. m., but other stores have a lot of late visitors. Also, maybe that store's most frequently borrowed movies are newly released ones, but other stores have lots of fans of classic movies. Therefore, the author needs evidence regarding customer preferences and habits, or else the suggestion may sound too optimistic.
Overall, evidence is lacking with regard to the author's argument. She needs to do more research before adamantly concluding that every branch store of Movies Galore reduce operating hours and inventory.

51. Humans arrived in the Kaliko Islands about 7,000 years ago, and within 3,000 years most of the large mammal species that had lived in the forests of the Kaliko Islands had become extinct. Yet humans cannot have been a factor in the species' extinctions, because there is no evidence that the humans had any significant contact with the mammals. Further, archaeologists have discovered numerous sites where the bones of fish had been discarded, but they found no such areas containing the bones of large mammals, so the humans cannot have hunted the mammals. Therefore, some climate change or other environmental factor must have caused the species' extinctions.

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

The article attributes the extinctions of large mammals on the Kaliko Islands to climate change or environmental factors. However, underlying its line of reasoning are several unwarranted assumptions that seriously undermine its soundness.
For starters, the author believes that humans could not have been responsible for the extinctions , because there is no evidence that humans had significant contact with the mammals. Clearly, the author assumes that any significant contact would have left noticeable tracks. However, perhaps after thousands of years of geological change, many traces of human activities have already been buried underneath. Volcanos, earthquakes, fires, and tsunamis could have completely eradicated any detectable evidence. Therefore, without ruling out these possibilities, the author cannot firmly deny the potential impact caused by humans.
In addition, the author mentions that archaeologists discovered sites where fish bones had been discarded, but found no similar sites with mammal bones, so she believes that humans must not have hunted the mammals. Clearly, she assumes that humans would have discarded the animal bones the way they did with the fish bones. However, perhaps fish bones were useless, so they would just throw them away once they consumed the fish. In contrast, animal bones could be used for weapons, tools, or decorations, so humans might have altered them for all kinds of purposes. Consequently, archeologists would not have discovered similar sites. Therefore, the author needs to provide more information to rule out these possibilities, or else the comparison between fish and mammals is not valid.

Finally, even if humans did not play a role , that does not necessarily mean that the extinctions must be attributed to climate or environmental factors. The author assumes that animal extinction can only be caused by these factors. However, viruses and plague can also eradicate species; lack of food, or introduction of new predators may also play a role. Without evidence investigating these possibilities, the author cannot firmly conclude that climate and environmental factors were ultimately responsible.

In sum, the author's argument has made too many unsupported assumptions. She needs to provide more information before legitimately drawing her conclusion.

72. The following appeared in a memo from the vice president of a food distribution company with food storage warehouses in several cities.

"Recently, we signed a contract with the Fly-Away Pest Control Company to provide pest control services at our fast-food warehouse in Palm City, but last month we discovered that over $20,000 worth of food there had been destroyed by pest damage. Meanwhile, the Buzzoff Pest Control Company, which we have used for many years, continued to service our warehouse in Wintervale, and last month only $10,000 worth of the food stored there had been destroyed by pest damage. Even though the price charged by Fly-Away is considerably lower, our best means of saving money is to return to Buzzoff for all our pest control services."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The article proposes that the company return to Buzzoff Pest Control Company for all its pest control services. However, the author needs to present more evidence to fully evaluate the soundness of the argument.

For starters, according to the author, the company's warehouse in Palm City（PC）, which is currently serviced by Fly- Away Pest Control Company, has lost $ 20, 000 worth of food to pest damage, in contrast to$ 10, 000 loss in the warehouse in Wintervale（WV）, which is serviced by Buzzoff. However, this difference does not prove that the former warehouse suffered heavier loss. The author assumes that the warehouse in PC did not store food with much higher overall value. Yet, perhaps the total quantity of stored food in the PC warehouse was more than twice that in the WV warehouse. If so, it might be the warehouse in WV that actually suffered heavier damage from pests. Therefore, the author needs more specific data regarding the total value of the food stored in each warehouse in order to rule out this possibility.

Second, even if the warehouse in PC had more food damage , that does not necessarily mean that the Fly- Away company was to blame. The author assumes that no other explanation could account for the data. However, perhaps PC and WV have completely different climates and temperatures. If PC is located in a relatively warmer and damper area, then the natural environment, rather than the pest- control company might be the key to the difference in food loss. Thus, the author needs to provide additional information to exclude these alternative explanations.

Finally, even if Buzzoff is better than Fly- Away at controlling pests , that does not necessarily mean that the author's company should return to using Buzzoff's service. She obviously assumes that the higher service fee Buzzoff charges does not offset its superior service. However, perhaps hiring Buzzoff is much more costly than hiring Fly- Away. As result, even though Fly- Away's pest control service is inferior, using its service will be the more financially prudent decision overall. Therefore , the author needs to provide specific data regarding the commission fees of the two pest control companies before drawing a conclusion.
Overall, the article lacks sufficient information for readers to ful ly evaluate its reasoning.

78. In a study of the reading habits of Waymarsh citizens conducted by the University of Waymarsh, most respondents said that they preferred literary classics as reading material. However, a second study conducted by the same researchers found that the type of book most frequently checked out of each of the public libraries in Waymarsh was the mystery novel. Therefore, it can be concluded that the respondents in the first study had misrepresented their reading habits.

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The author of the passage believes that the respondents in the first study had mispresented their reading habits. However, more evidence is needed to fully evaluate this reasoning.
For starters, according to the first survey, most respondents said that they preferred literary classics as reading material. The author clearly assumes that the respondents selected would have represented the reading habits of all Waymarsh citizens, assuming had they told the truth. However, perhaps they were indeed telling the truth about what they read, but they still would not represent the whole city's reading habits. Their numbers could be small due to surveyors not bothering to collect a large amount of data. The survey could have been conducted outside of libraries, where most respondents have a habit of reading serious books. Thus, without more concrete information regarding how the survey was conducted, readers cannot hastily agree that its respondents were dishonest.
Second, the second study found that the type of book most frequently checked out of each of the public libraries was the mystery novel. However, that does not mean that Waymarsh citizens prefer mystery novels in general, unless the author assumes that the second study is accurate and reliable. People don't necessarily borrow books especially for the topics that they are most enthusiastic about. Instead, they most likely buy those books to have a copy at home. Consequently, library lists may not reliably reflect people's reading habits. Therefore, the author needs more direct evidence in order to establish a connection between books checked- out from libraries and people's reading habits.
Finally, even if the second study was reliable, that does not necessarily mean that the first was not. The author assumes that the two results were incompatible with each other. However, it is very

possible that the two studies were both valid, and that is only because they were conducted at different times that they achieved different results. If a new movie adapted from a mystery novel was released, then it could ignite people's interest in mystery novels. Without evidence ruling out this possibility, the author cannot completely deny the first study.
Overall, the evidence from the passage is insufficient to warrant the author's conclusion. She needs to provide more information in order to fully persuade readers.

79. The following appeared in a memo at XYZ company.
"When XYZ lays off employees, it pays Delany Personnel Firm to offer those employees assistance in creating résumés and developing interviewing skills, if they so desire. Laid-off employees have benefited greatly from Delany's services: last year those who used Delany found jobs much more quickly than did those who did not. Recently, it has been proposed that we use the less expensive Walsh Personnel Firm in place of Delany. This would be a mistake because eight years ago, when XYZ was using Walsh, only half of the workers we laid off at that time found jobs within a year. Moreover, Delany is clearly superior, as evidenced by its bigger staff and larger number of branch offices. After all, last year Delany's clients took an average of six months to find jobs, whereas Walsh's clients took nine."

Write a response in which you discuss what specific evidence is needed to evaluate the argument and explain how the evidence would weaken or strengthen the argument.

The article recommends that XYZ Company not switch from Delany Personnel Firm to Walsh Personnel Firm for helping laid- off employees with job placement. However, more evidence is needed for a thorough evaluation of this reasoning.
For starters, the author mentions that last year, those who used Delany found jobs more quickly than did those who did not; in contrast, eight years ago, when XYZ used Walsh, only half of the laid off workers found jobs within a year. Clearly, the author assumes that the job market has not changed much during the past eight years. However, perhaps eight years ago, the economy was receding, so it was quite a difficult task for an employee to find a new job. Therefore, being able to help half of the employees secure a new position could have been quite an amazing achievement for XYZ. In contrast, last year could have been a good year for job seekers. Perhaps the Economy was thriving and new jobs were always available. Therefore, what Delany was able to do was not at all an achievement. Simply put, more evidence comparing the job market eight years ago with that of last year would be useful to evaluate the author's argument.
Second, the author mentions that Delany has a bigger staff and larger number of branch offices, and she believes that these differences indicate Delany's superiority. Clearly, she assumes that only a better company can have a larger staff and more branch offices. However, it is possible that

the reason Delany needs so many people is that it runs extremely inefficiently. Also, many of its branches may be functioning poorly, and a large proportion could be facing the possibility of closing. Therefore, without knowing how well these branches are operating, readers will not be fully persuaded by the author's reasoning.

Last, the author mentions that last year Delany's clients took an average of six months to find jobs, whereas Walsh's clients took nine. Apparently, she assumes that the only reason for this statistical difference is Delany's superior ability to help clients. However, many other possibilities could equally account for the data. Perhaps Delaney's clients were better educated , and therefore more qualified for new jobs. Perhaps Delaney tricked its clients into pursuing low- profile jobs. If these were true, then Delaney's clients would easily find new jobs. Therefore, without evidence ruling out these alternatives, the author's conclusion cannot firmly stand.

Overall, the author has to provide additional information to address all aforementioned issues. Until then, readers are very unlikely to be convinced by her reasoning.

125. The following appeared in a letter to the school board in the town of Centerville.

"All students should be required to take the driver's education course at Centerville High School. In the past two years, several accidents in and around Centerville have involved teenage drivers. Since a number of parents in Centerville have complained that they are too busy to teach their teenagers to drive, some other instruction is necessary to ensure that these teenagers are safe drivers. Although there are two driving schools in Centerville, parents on a tight budget cannot afford to pay for driving instruction. Therefore an effective and mandatory program sponsored by the high school is the only solution to this serious problem."

Write a response in which you examine the stated and/or unstated assumptions of the argument. Be sure to explain how the argument depends on these assumptions and what the implications are for the argument if the assumptions prove unwarranted.

The author suggests that Centerville High School set up a mandatory driving course for all of its students. However, underlying her line of reasoning are several unwarranted assumptions that seriously undermine the argument's cogency.

For starters, the author mentions that in the past two years , several accidents in and around Centerville have involved teenage drivers. Clearly, she assumes that these accidents are directly attributable to students from Centerville High school. However, perhaps these accidents were just a few sporadic accidents, not caused by the teenage drivers. These teenagers could have been victims rather than villains, and some other adult drivers who drove recklessly had caused the accidents. Therefore, without more specific information regarding the accidents, the author cannot conclude that there is a serious driving problem for Centerville High School students.

Second, the author mentions that many parents complained that they are too busy to teach their children to drive, implying that parents cannot be the solution. Clearly, the author assumes that these parents' complaints are sincere and representative of most parents. However, perhaps these people are just lazy, and wish to assign what should be their own responsibility to someone else. They would rather spend their spare time watching TV or playing poker. Therefore, the author needs to look into the complaints before deciding that the school should carry the obligation.

Lastly, the author claims that parents on a tight budget cannot afford driving schools , so she believes that driving schools are not the solution , either. In contrast, however, she assumes that these relatively poor families would able buy their teenagers cars. However, if parents really cannot afford driving classes for their children, it is quite unlikely that they will be able to buy their children cars. Therefore, without specific information to address the question of how many teenage drivers from the school come from families that cannot afford driving schools, the author cannot simply rule out this alternative solution.

Overall, the article suffers from too many unwarranted assumptions. Without more evidence to supplement these loopholes, the author will fail to persuade readers to accept her proposal.